

Vocabulary 05: Make It, Mend It, Wear It

Unit 5, Apparel and Textile Production and Design. The unit's 66 Tier 3 words across the five topics, with a one-line definition written for a grade 6 to 7 reader and a Spanish column.

Translation status. The Spanish column is my best working translation and has not been checked by a native speaker. Use it for word banks and picture cards; have a native speaker, a bilingual colleague, or the ENL teacher check the whole table once before it is printed for students. Tool and stitch names are the worst case. Sewing words drift by country and by trade: what one country calls a stitch, another calls something else, and a few of these have no single everyday word in Spanish. **The English term stays on every card**, because a student will see the English word on a real care label, a real pattern envelope, a real tool, and a real store tag.

Two words do double duty and the table says which meaning is meant. "Pattern" here is the paper shape you cut fabric from, not a repeating print (the repeating print is the art word, and it belongs to Unit 4). "Shank" here is the small stack of thread under a button that gives it room to fasten, not the part of a tool.

How lessons use this file: each lesson names its own Tier 3 words, and the handout for that lesson carries a word bank pulled from this table in both languages. The site's Materials page prints the table as picture-ready cards. **The card is allowed as a word bank on the Unit 5 Test**, because the test is checking whether a student can choose a stitch and run a comparison, not whether they can spell "whipstitch."

The table

#	Topic	English term	Student definition	Spanish
1	5.3	fiber	The thinnest thread-like part that fabric is made from. Every fabric starts as fiber.	fibra
2	5.3	natural fiber	A fiber that comes from a plant or an animal.	fibra natural
3	5.3	manufactured fiber	A fiber made in a factory, usually from chemicals.	fibra sintética (fibra manufacturada)
4	5.3	cotton	A natural fiber	algodón

			from a plant. Soft, soaks up water, and takes a while to dry.	
5	5.3	wool	A natural fiber from a sheep. Warm even when damp, and it shrinks in hot water.	lana
6	5.3	silk	A natural fiber from a silkworm. Smooth, light, strong, and usually washed by hand.	seda
7	5.3	linen	A natural fiber from the flax plant. Cool to wear and it wrinkles easily.	lino
8	5.3	polyester	A manufactured fiber. Dries fast, holds its shape, and melts instead of burning.	poliéster
9	5.3	nylon	A manufactured fiber. Strong and slippery, used in jackets, tights, and bags.	naïlon
10	5.3	spandex	A manufactured fiber that stretches and snaps back. High heat ruins it.	elastano (licra)
11	5.3	rayon	A manufactured fiber made from wood.	viscosa (rayón)

			Feels soft like cotton but is weaker when wet.	
12	5.3	fabric	The cloth itself, made by weaving or knitting fiber together.	tela
13	5.3	weave (woven)	Fabric made by crossing threads over and under each other. It does not stretch much and the cut edge frays.	tejido plano (trama)
14	5.3	knit	Fabric made from loops of thread. It stretches, and the cut edge curls.	tejido de punto
15	5.3	swatch	A small square of fabric used for testing.	muestra de tela
16	5.3	wicking	When fabric pulls sweat away from your skin so it can dry.	absorber y secar rápido (transporte de humedad)
17	5.4	care label	The tag sewn into a garment that says how to wash and dry it. The law says it has to be there.	etiqueta de cuidado
18	5.4	care symbol	The small picture on a care label. Dots mean temperature,	símbolo de cuidado

			bars mean be gentler, an X means do not do it.	
19	5.4	colorfast	A fabric whose color stays put and does not run onto other clothes.	que no destiñe (color firme)
20	5.4	stain	A mark on fabric from something spilled on it.	mancha
21	5.4	pretreat	To work on a stain before the garment goes in the wash.	pretratar (tratar antes de lavar)
22	5.4	launder	To wash, dry, and fold clothes.	lavar la ropa
23	5.5	hand needle	The small steel tool with an eye that carries thread through fabric. A smaller number means a bigger needle.	aguja de mano
24	5.5	pin	A straight steel pin with a head, used to hold two pieces of fabric together before you stitch.	alfiler
25	5.5	pin cushion	The small cushion where every needle and pin lives when it is not in a hand.	alfiletero
26	5.5	thimble	A hard cap for the finger that	dedal

			pushes the needle through thick fabric.	
27	5.5	needle threader	A small tool that pulls thread through the eye of a needle for you.	enhebrador de aguja
28	5.5	fabric shears	Large scissors for cutting fabric. Fabric only, never paper, ever.	tijeras de tela
29	5.5	snips	Small scissors for cutting thread close to the fabric.	tijeras para hilo
30	5.5	seam ripper	A small hooked tool that opens a line of stitching that went wrong.	descosedor (abrecosturas)
31	5.5	measuring tape	The soft tape, usually 60 inches long, for measuring fabric and a body.	cinta métrica
32	5.5	tailor's chalk	Chalk that marks the cut line and the seam line on fabric and brushes off later.	jaboncillo de sastre (tiza de sastre)
33	5.6	thread	The long strand you sew with. Cut it about the distance from your hand to your elbow.	hilo
34	5.6	knot	The bump you tie at the end of	nudo

			the thread so the stitching cannot pull out.	
35	5.6	stitch	One pass of the needle in and out of the fabric.	puntada
36	5.6	running stitch	In, out, in, out, along a line. Fast, and not strong. Good for basting and for a drawstring channel.	puntada corrida
37	5.7	backstitch	A stitch that goes back into the last hole, so the top looks like a solid line. The strong one. Use it on any seam that holds weight.	pespunte (puntada atrás)
38	5.7	whipstitch	A slanted stitch that goes over two edges and joins them, or finishes a raw edge.	puntada de sobrehilado
39	5.11	blanket stitch	A stitch along an edge that makes an L shape. It joins and decorates at the same time.	punto de festón (punto de manta)
40	5.7	seam	The line where two pieces of fabric are stitched together.	costura
41	5.7, 5.10	seam allowance	The space between the cut	margen de costura

			edge and the stitching line. Usually about half an inch. Forget it and the seam tears out.	
42	5.9	hem	The folded and stitched bottom edge of pants, a skirt, or a sleeve.	dobladillo
43	5.9	patch	A piece of fabric stitched over a hole to cover and hold it.	parche
44	5.9	mend	To fix a garment that is torn, open, or missing something.	remendar (arreglar)
45	5.9	visible mending	Fixing something on purpose so the repair shows, usually in bright thread.	remiendo visible
46	5.8	button	The small round fastener that goes through a buttonhole.	botón
47	5.8	shank	The little stack of thread under a button that leaves room for the fabric. No shank, no fastening.	cueillo del botón (holgura de hilo)
48	5.10	pattern	The paper shape you trace and cut the fabric from.	patrón (molde)

49	5.16	mock-up	A quick test version, usually in paper, of the hardest part, built before you cut the real fabric.	maqueta (modelo de prueba)
50	5.15	upcycle	To turn something used into something new that is worth as much or more. Not the same as shredding it.	suprarreciclar (darle un uso nuevo y mejor)
51	5.12	secondhand	Already owned by somebody else. Sold as it is, with no returns, so you inspect it yourself.	de segunda mano
52	5.13	cost per wear	The price divided by the number of times you actually wear it. The real cost of a garment.	costo por uso
53	5.14	fast fashion	Clothing made fast, in huge amounts, cheap and thin, and built to last a few washes.	moda rápida
54	5.14	textile waste	Clothing and fabric that gets thrown out instead of worn, reused, or recycled.	residuo textil
55	5.19	alteration	A change made to a garment so it fits better,	arreglo (ajuste de ropa)

			like taking it in or shortening it.	
56	5.19	tailor	A person who makes and alters clothing to fit one specific body, for a living.	sastre
57	5.10	sewing machine	The machine that sews the same stitch your hands do, faster. It does not know your finger is there.	máquina de coser
58	5.10	presser foot	The metal foot that holds the fabric down so the feed dogs can move it.	prensateles
59	5.10	feed dogs	The metal teeth under the foot that pull the fabric through. You guide, you never push.	dientes de arrastre
60	5.10	bobbin	The small spool of bottom thread under the needle plate. Every machine stitch is two threads locking together.	bobina (canilla)
61	5.10	take-up lever	The slotted arm at the top that the top thread rides. It pulls the slack up on every stitch.	palanca del hilo
62	5.10	hand wheel	The big wheel on the side that	volante

			moves the needle one stitch at a time. Always turned toward you.	
63	5.10	foot pedal	The machine's gas. It controls speed, which is why the other foot stays flat on the floor.	pedal
64	5.10	tension	How tight the machine holds the top thread. Wrong tension makes loops on one side of the seam.	tensión del hilo
65	5.10	pivot	Turning the fabric at a corner with the needle down and the foot up.	girar con la aguja abajo (pivote)
66	5.11	reverse (backstitch lever)	The lever that sews backward to lock the ends of a machine seam.	retroceso (palanca de remate)

Sentence starters

Print these on the back of the station count sheet, the feedback slip, and the 45-second planner.

Asking for help at a sewing station (Lessons 5.5 to 5.11, 5.16 to 5.18)

Use these after the three steps of the stuck protocol: read your plan again, look at the stitch card, then ask your station partner.

English	Spanish
Can you show me this stitch again, slowly?	¿Me puedes mostrar esta puntada otra vez, despacio?
I need a threader, please.	Necesito un enhebrador, por favor.
My thread keeps pulling out. Here is where	Mi hilo se sale siempre. Aquí es donde pasa.

it happens.	
I am on step ___ of my plan.	Estoy en el paso ___ de mi plan.
Is this the right stitch for here?	¿Es esta la puntada correcta para aquí?
How far from the edge should I stitch?	¿A qué distancia del borde debo coser?
I dropped a pin. I have it.	Se me cayó un alfiler. Ya lo tengo.
Can you hold this corner while I stitch?	¿Puedes sostener esta esquina mientras coso?
I put the Need Help card up and I am working on ___ while I wait.	Levanté la tarjeta de ayuda y estoy haciendo ___ mientras espero.

The count-out and count-in routine (every day tools are out)

The Station Manager says these out loud. Everybody else answers.

English	Spanish
Counting out: ten needles, thirty pins.	Contando al inicio: diez agujas, treinta alfileres.
I am writing the number on the count sheet.	Estoy escribiendo el número en la hoja de conteo.
Every needle and pin is in a hand or in the cushion.	Cada aguja y alfiler está en una mano o en el alfiletero.
Five minutes. Everything goes back in the cushion.	Cinco minutos. Todo vuelve al alfiletero.
Counting in: ten needles, thirty pins.	Contando al final: diez agujas, treinta alfileres.
The numbers match. Ready for your initials.	Los números coinciden. Listo para su firma.
The numbers do not match. We are one short.	Los números no coinciden. Falta uno.
Nobody leaves this station until we find it.	Nadie sale de esta estación hasta que lo encontremos.
Shears closed, blades down, handle first.	Tijeras cerradas, hojas abajo, mango primero.
Our station is clean. The floor is clear.	Nuestra estación está limpia. El piso está despejado.

Giving feedback on a classmate's item (Lessons 5.10 and 5.18, two stars and a step)

Name a specific feature. "It is nice" is not feedback.

English	Spanish
Two things that work: ___ and ___.	Dos cosas que funcionan: ___ y ___.

Your stitches are even right here.	Tus puntadas están muy parejas aquí.
The closure works. I tried it.	El cierre funciona. Lo probé.
I would not have guessed it was a ____ before.	No habría adivinado que antes era un ____.
One thing to try: ____.	Una cosa para intentar: ____.
The edge here could use a whipstitch.	A este borde le vendría bien una puntada de sobrehilado.
What was the hardest part for you?	¿Cuál fue la parte más difícil para ti?
How did you fix that?	¿Cómo arreglaste eso?
I want to try this idea on my next one.	Quiero probar esta idea en el mío próximo.

The 45-second explanation at the gallery (Lesson 5.18)

Four parts, in this order, pointing at the item while you talk. Stop when the timer goes.

English	Spanish
This was a ____.	Esto era un ____.
It came from ____ (the scrap bin, the drive, my house).	Vino de ____ (la caja de retazos, la donación, mi casa).
Now it is a ____ for ____.	Ahora es un ____ para ____.
They will use it to ____.	Lo va a usar para ____.
I used the running stitch here.	Usé la puntada corrida aquí.
I used the backstitch here because it is strong.	Usé el pespunte aquí porque es fuerte.
I used the whipstitch on this edge.	Usé la puntada de sobrehilado en este borde.
The hard part was ____.	La parte difícil fue ____.
I fixed it by ____.	Lo arreglé ____.
I also added ____ so that ____.	También le agregué ____ para que ____.
To wash it, ____.	Para lavarlo, ____.
Do you have a question about it?	¿Tienen alguna pregunta sobre esto?